Mitrany argued that international peace may be established through the promotion of cooperation organized around basic functional needs such as health, transportation, educational and cultural activities, trade and other kinds of activities. He opined that there would be as many as international organizations as required, and these would be organized on a universal rather than a regional basis. In contrast to Mitrany, Haas‡ was more interested in the study of regional integration as a process "whereby political actors in several discrete political settings are persuaded to shift their loyalties and political activities towards a new center whose institutions possess or demand jurisdiction over pre-existing national states". That is, he wondered whether the establishment of a supranational organization among a group of states (in a region) and the issues around which the process of integration would be set were primarily of economic nature rather than political. For Haas, integration was the tendency towards voluntary creation of larger political units where each avoids the use of force in relations with the participating units and groups. The primary actors in the integration process would be the 'integrationist-technocrats' and various interest groups who would persuade their governments to establish a regional economic integration organization for a variety of 'convergent aims'. Achievement of integration then would result from a cumulative and expansive process through which the functions of the organization would slowly increase, and it would exercise authority over an ever-expanding area of decision-making activities. The necessary assumption that follows, according to Haas, is that progress from a politically inspired common market to economic union, and finally to political union would be automatic.[12]

According to Kegley and Wittkopf[13], neo-functionalism proposes to reach its ultimate goal of a supranational community, not by avoiding controversial issue areas but by stressing cooperation in areas that are politically controversial. It proposes to overcome the political obstacles standing in the way of cooperation by demonstrating the benefits common to all members of a potential union.

Neo-functionalists like Schmitter and Haas, had developed neo-function-alist paradigm for comparative analysis. They had identified